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JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Eric Henderson (left) worked with Caise Oliver of Acushnet at the Bedrock Recovery Center in Canton.

SHOWING THE WAY TO ADDICTION RECOVERY

Peer coach brings the perspective of an ex-user to those who are struggling

By Chris Serres
GLOBE STAFF

As a child, Eric Henderson was desperate to be accepted by the guys on his corner. His first arrest was for brawling at a shopping mall at 11. When his fellow gang members on Fayston Street in Roxbury wanted to intimidate a rival, it was Henderson, then a teenager, who would volunteer to fire the gun or drive the getaway car. On the streets, his exploits earned him the nickname “Fame.”

Like many others in his group, Henderson ended up addicted to cocaine and heroin, and spent much of his early adulthood bouncing

from prison to the streets.

Then came a crushing blow. On April 9, 2011, Henderson arrived home to discover his father’s body face down on his bed. That initial horror was followed by another: Some potent pills Henderson had stashed in his bedroom had been opened. An autopsy later revealed the pills had triggered his father’s fatal heart attack.

“The bottom fell out of me,” Henderson said. “I had to live with the guilt that I had killed my own father.”

Devastated, Henderson forged a new path. He is now free from his addiction and

among hundreds of former users joining the ranks of certified peer recovery coaches, non-medical experts who rely on their past experiences to motivate clients to keep away from alcohol and drugs.

After decades operating on the margins of the substance use treatment industry, recovery coaches are increasingly being integrated into mainstream medicine as the state works to stem the tide of overdose deaths, a crisis that has claimed more than 20,000 lives in Massachusetts in the past decade. The number of coaches has grown and is expected to

COACH, Page A10

Proponents of gun rights see an opening here after court ruling

By Dan Glaun
GLOBE STAFF

Gun rights advocates in Massachusetts have mounted a coordinated campaign of lawsuits they hope will overturn the state’s century-old firearm license system, emboldened by a 2022 US Supreme Court decision that limited how much discretion authorities have in deciding who may carry guns in public.

From Boston to the Berkshires, gun applicants and advocacy groups have brought at least 15 challenges to the state’s license-to-carry law that have made their way to Superior Courts and that could reach the state’s high court. A coalition of local and national gun rights groups separately sued in federal court in February to overturn a state law that bans 18-, 19-, and 20-year-olds from possessing handguns or semiautomatic firearms. And gun advocates have also pledged to appeal a March Supreme Judicial Court decision allow-

GUNS, Page A6

Trump backlash brings Democrats together

By Tal Kopan
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — As President Trump marked the first 100 days of his administration this week, he has prominently touted his far-reaching crack-down on undocumented immigrants and antisemitism.

But rather than being put on the defensive, Democrats see

his actions as providing an opening on issues that a mere few months ago were among their weakest spots politically.

After the detention of immigrant students and dramatic funding cuts to universities under the banner of combating antisemitism, the dynamics of the issues of immigration and campus unrest that once fa-

vored Republicans seem to be shifting, both in Washington and with voters. A swath of recent public polls show the public souring on Trump’s handling of immigration, with approval rates of his policies falling markedly in the past month.

Democrats, once torn by divisions over Israel’s intense

ANTISEMITISM, Page A6

MAY DAY MARCHERS

More than 1,000 people rallied on Boston Common to honor labor unions and support workers’ rights, while taking aim at President Trump and his policies. Similar protests were held around the country Thursday. **A5, B1-2.**

Federal prosecutors in Vermont are appealing a judge’s order releasing Mohsen Mahdawi. B1.

Some insurers will stop covering drugs such as Ozempic and Wegovy, and people may have to make some decisions. The Fine Print, B5.



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

New leader makes changes in State Police

Training academy overhaul set after recruit’s death

By Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF

The new head of the Massachusetts State Police made his first major shake-up on Thursday to an agency long beset by scandal and problems, directing an overhaul of the training academy where a recruit died last year under mysterious circumstances.

Colonel Geoffrey D. Noble replaced the head of academy, commissioned an independent review of training practices, and, for the first time, split the incoming class of recruits into two smaller sessions. The Massachusetts academy has a much higher attrition rate among recruits than other police programs around the country.

They are among the first significant structural changes to the academy since 25-year-old Enrique Delgado-Garcia died after suffering serious injuries in a boxing ring during an academy training exercise in New Braintree in September.

The tragedy renewed calls for drastic change for an agency beleaguered by scandals including corruption, abuse of overtime pay, and questionable conduct, such as its investigation in the Karen Read case. Delgado-Garcia died just weeks be-

TRAINING, Page A10

In shake-up, Waltz out as security adviser

Rubio will step in while remaining secretary of state

By Maggie Haberman, David E. Sanger, and Jonathan Swan
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — President Trump on Thursday removed his national security adviser, Michael Waltz, and nominated him as ambassador to the United Nations, the first significant personnel overhaul of top White House aides and the kind of shake-up that Trump had sought to avoid in his second term.

Secretary of State Marco Rubio will serve as interim national security adviser and will remain the nation’s top diplomat, Trump said.

“From his time in uniform on the battlefield, in Congress and, as my National Security Advisor, Mike Waltz has worked hard to put our Nation’s Interests first,” Trump wrote in a post on social media. “I know he will do the same in his new role.”

Waltz had been on thin ice as national security adviser for months, but his position became more

WALTZ, Page A7

Crashing the party

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